Sentinel

A forensic reader for Indian financial statements. It reads the notes nobody reads, and shows its work.

Every flag is traced to a page of the filing and the words printed there. Every number is checked in code, and a number that cannot be checked is dropped, never repaired.

437

WHAT A FLAG LOOKS LIKE · PAGE 437 OF 683

"(b) A report under sub-section (12) of section 143 of the Companies Act has been filed by us in Form ADT-4."

Auditor's CARO annexure, clause (xi), standalone. From a published FY26 annual report; raised by the reader as a non-clean answer for a person to read.

PREPARED

October 2026. Product views in this document use a seeded demo company; every result quoted comes from five published FY26 annual reports.

The warning is in the notes. Nobody reads the notes.

An Indian annual report runs to hundreds of pages. The headline numbers are on a handful of them. What the auditor was uneasy about, how much customers owe beyond a year, what is lent to the promoter group, how much debt falls due next year: those answers sit in annexures and notes, in tables that every company lays out differently.

Databases give you the headline figures. A general-purpose AI will summarise a PDF fluently and sometimes misquote it. Sentinel does the third thing: it **reads the specific notes a forensic analyst would, checks the arithmetic, and hands back each finding with its page and the printed words**, so a person can verify it in seconds.

683
pages in the longest of five FY26 reports read (Tech Mahindra); the shortest has 360

6
kinds of note read today, each with its own reader and its own arithmetic check

0.3–0.5s
to read the notes of a whole report once it is loaded; no model is called

HOW A FINDING IS MADE

1 READ
Rules, not a model, find each note in the PDF, however the company laid it out. The same file gives the same answer every time.

2 VERIFY
Rows must add up. Ageing buckets sum to the total; a printed variance must follow from its two figures. A row that fails is dropped.

3 CITE
Each finding carries its page and the words as printed, and says when a note was *not read*, which is not the same as "clean".

4 RANK
High, medium or information, against stated starting thresholds, and weighted by how much of your book sits under the company.

WHO IT IS FOR

Credit analysts at banks and NBFCs appraising borrowers, most of them unlisted, so no database covers them: the borrower or their CA sends the file through an upload link. Then **equity analysts** who want a forensic layer on companies they already cover.

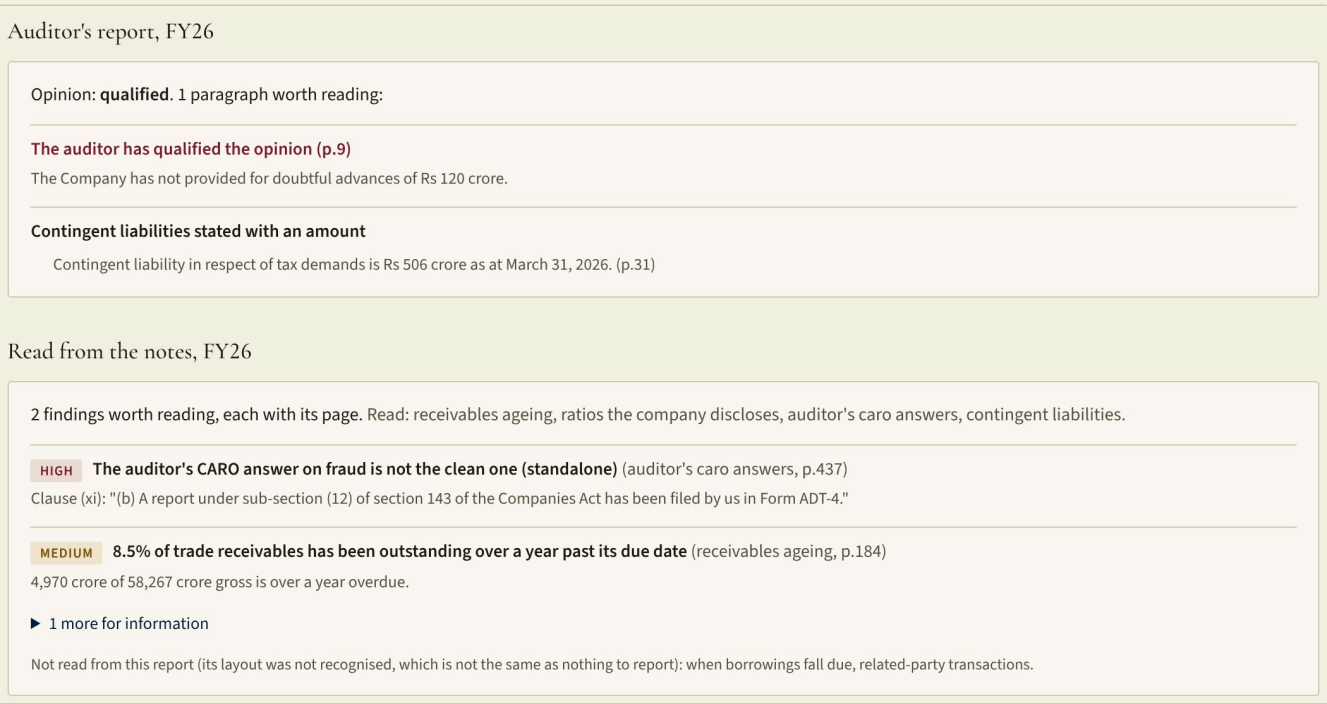
THE TEST FOR EVERY FEATURE

Does it help someone *find what is wrong in a filing and prove it from the page*? If not, it is hidden or dropped. Valuation, presentation decks and price feeds are deliberately not the focus.

Six notes, read the way an auditor would.

NOTE	WHAT IT CHECKS	WHY IT MATTERS	HOW IT IS KEPT HONEST
Receivables ageing	How much of what customers owe is a year or more past due, and how much is marked credit-impaired.	A long overdue tail is where revenue that was never really collected hides.	Gross less allowance is checked against the net figure printed on the page: 22 of 22 tables tied.
Auditor's CARO answers	The auditor's statutory answers on assets, loans, statutory dues, fraud, going concern and group companies.	These sit in an annexure few people open, and a non-clean answer is the auditor telling you something.	Negation-aware: a clean 'no fraud noticed' is not raised as adverse. Quoted word for word.
Related-party transactions	Loans, deposits, guarantees, sales and purchases with the promoter group and subsidiaries.	The oldest forensic question: is the company lending to, or selling mostly to, people it is tied to?	A row is kept only if its party columns add up to its printed total.
Contingent liabilities	What the company could owe if disputes go against it, none of it on the balance sheet.	Large claims against net worth change the risk of every other number.	Both table and prose forms; the year-on-year change and size against net worth are given.
When borrowings fall due	The contractual maturity table: how much debt falls due within a year.	A balance sheet shows the debt; this shows the wall.	A bucket is accepted only if the buckets add to the printed total. Materiality is stated, not hidden.
Ratios the company discloses	Current ratio, debt-equity, margins and the rest of the Schedule III ratio table.	The company's own figures, cross-checked against what Sentinel computes from the statements.	Each printed variance must follow from its two figures, or the row is dropped.

IN THE PRODUCT ILLUSTRATIVE DATA



Findings on a company's page. The auditor's opinion, then the notes: a high finding, a medium one, and a plain statement of which notes the reader *did not* recognise in this report. Demo company; the wording mirrors a finding the reader raised on a real report.

Ranked by how much of your money sits under it.

Add your holdings by hand or from a broker file. Each position is weighted (by market value when every holding has a price, otherwise by cost, and the page says which), and each finding is multiplied by that weight. The list that comes out is ordered by how much of your book sits under a problem.

3	61.3%	38.7%	0.0%	₹55,500
HOLDINGS	BOOK UNDER A HIGH FINDING	BOOK WITH NO ANNUAL REPORT READ	BOOK WHOSE NEXT REPORT SHOULD BE OUT	MARKET VALUE

Weights are by market value: quantity times the price on each company's Settings page. "No annual report read" is a blind spot, not a clean result: nothing was found because nothing was read.

COMPANY	WEIGHT	PRICE	GAIN	ANNUAL REPORT READ	FINDINGS	
Alpha Tyres 100 shares - ₹34,000	61.3%	₹340	+13.3%	FY26	High The auditor's CARO answer on fraud is not the clean one (standalone) (p.437) High The auditor has qualified the opinion (p.9) High Working capital line: covenant breached 2 more on the project page	Edit Remove
Apex Reference Tyres 100 shares - ₹12,000	21.6%	₹120	+20.0%	not read	-	Edit Remove
Lakh Industries 50 shares - ₹9,500	17.1%	₹190	-5.0%	not read no statements on file	-	Edit Remove

Portfolio. Weight, price, gain, which annual report was read, and the findings with their pages. “Not read” is shown as a blind spot, with the share of the book it covers: nothing found because nothing was read. ILLUSTRATIVE DATA

THE MORNING DIGEST OPENS WITH IT

Your book under a finding (1)

Alpha Tyres - 61.3% of your book: The auditor's CARO answer on fraud is not the clean one (standalone)

Auditor's CARO answers, FY26: Clause (xi): "(b) A report under sub-section (12) of section 143 of the Companies Act has been filed by us in Form ADT-4." (p.437) 4 more findings.

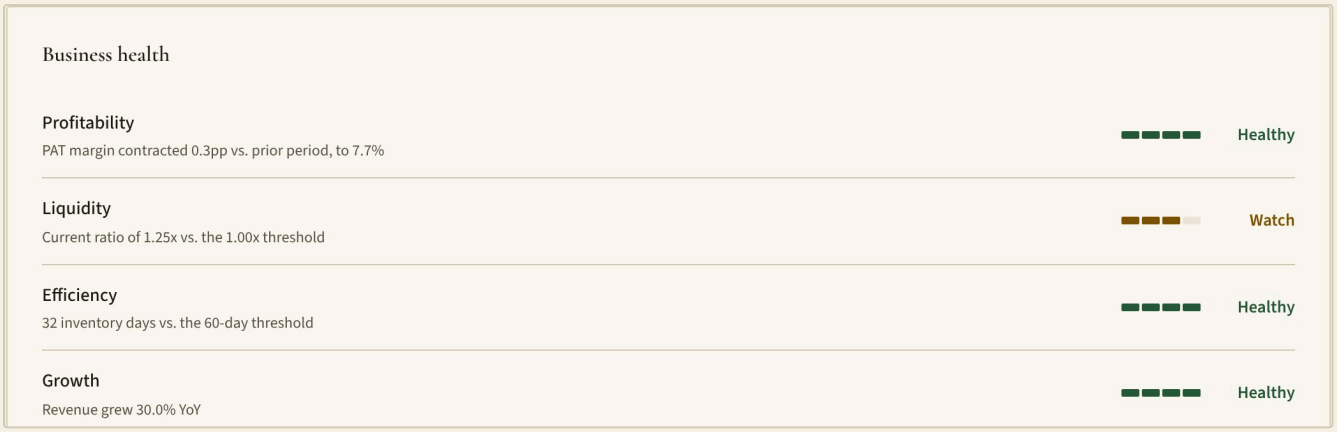
From the notes to the accounts (1)

Alpha Tyres - FY26: The auditor's CARO answer on fraud is not the clean one (standalone)

Auditor's CARO answers, p.437. Clause (xi): "(b) A report under sub-section (12) of section 143 of the Companies Act has been filed by us in Form ADT-4." 1 more in the notes.

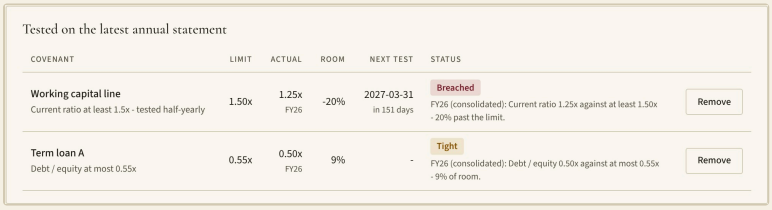
Coverage digest. One ranked list of what needs attention across the companies you cover: new filings, the auditor’s report, the notes, covenants, overdue figures. The score orders your reading; it is not a measure of risk.

The supporting work an analyst does anyway.



Business health. Eight checks, each with its threshold written out (four shown), and "no data" where the figures are not on file rather than a guess.
ILLUSTRATIVE DATA

- **Bring files in any way they come.** Text PDF, CSV, Excel, an exchange XBRL file, scanned PDFs by OCR on the pages you name, a trial balance, or an upload link a borrower's CA fills in.
- **Forensic scores with their formulas.** Piotroski F, Altman Z″, Beneish M, credit ratios, free cash flow and conversion, each showing how it was computed.
- **Covenant tracker.** Enter a lender's limit once; Sentinel tests it against the latest annual figures and says how much room is left.
- **Peers and trends,** with the peer set limited to companies you are allowed to see.
- **Investigations.** Anomaly flags first, then a drafted narrative in which every figure is checked against the data before it is shown.
- **Annual report fetch from BSE** by scrip code or a pasted bseindia.com address, read like any upload. *Not yet verified against the live site.*



Covenants. A breached limit and a tight one, each with the ratio, the limit and the room left. ILLUSTRATIVE DATA



Fetch from BSE. The card says in its own words that it is unverified against the live site.

BUILT TO BE TRUSTED WITH A BORROWER'S NUMBERS

Private by construction. Holdings, covenants and requests are stored in tables closed to the browser and reached only through server routes that check who is asking.

A source for every figure. The statement behind each number, the file it came from and the history of every change are kept.

Tested. 776 automated tests pass, with 84 browser checks; the readers are tested on real FY26 reports, not just synthetic text.

Not another dashboard. A reader that shows its work.

Most tools in this space answer “what are the numbers?”. Sentinel answers “what in this filing should I read, and where is it?”. Compared with the usual ways of doing that job:

	READING BY HAND	DATABASES AND SCREENERS	GENERAL AI OVER A PDF	SENTINEL
Where the answer comes from	The analyst’s attention and time	Structured headline fields, typically	A language model’s reading of the text	**Rules and arithmetic on the page**
Cites the page and the printed words	If the analyst writes them down	Rarely for notes	Can misquote or mis-cite	**Every finding, always**
Says what it could not read	No record of what was skipped	Silent gaps	Fluent even when wrong	**“Not read” is reported separately from “clean”**
Same file, same answer	Varies by reader and day	Yes	Varies run to run	**Yes: no model in the reading**
Checks its own numbers	If time allows	Source-dependent	Not by construction	**Rows that do not add up are dropped**
Works on unlisted borrowers	Yes, slowly	Only what is in the database	Yes	**Yes: upload, or a link the CA fills in**
Weighs findings by your position	In the analyst’s head	Screens, not findings	No	**Weight × severity, with the basis stated**

The middle columns describe the usual shape of each approach, not any one product. Where a competing tool does more than shown, the row should be read as the typical case.

> *Never repair a number. If a row does not add up, drop it and say so.*
>
> The rule behind every reader: a wrong figure shown with confidence is worse than a missing one.

> *“Not read” is not “clean”.*
>
> A report whose related-party note is in a layout the reader does not recognise is reported as not read. The portfolio shows the share of the book that is a blind spot.

WHAT IS DELIBERATELY NOT HERE

Valuation and price feeds (where terminals win and Sentinel has no edge), presentation decks and management dashboards. The product is narrow on purpose: a credit analyst or an equity analyst should be able to say what it does in one sentence.

What was measured, and what has not been.

The readers were run over five published FY26 annual reports. A green cell is a note the reader recognised and the number of tables, clauses or rows it read; a hatched cell is a note it did not recognise, which is **not** a statement that the note is clean.

	Receivables ageing	Disclosed ratios	Auditor's CARO	Contingent liabilities	Borrowings due	Related parties	High / Medium
TCS 360 pages	8	10	10	3	not read	68	0 / 1
Infosys 383 pages	2	9	9	2	10	not read	0 / 0
HCLTech 462 pages	4	27	10	1	not read	not read	0 / 0
Wipro 548 pages	4	14	9	3	52	not read	2 / 1
Tech Mahindra 683 pages	4	10	10	10	18	68	2 / 3

22/22
receivables tables whose gross less allowance tied to the printed net

9
findings at high or medium across the five reports (4 high, 5 medium), each with its page

3 of 5
reports with nothing at high: TCS, Infosys, HCLTech

58–65%
statement figures right when read from a whole report: the known weak spot

What these results do not show

- **Precision.** Nobody outside the project has yet marked the findings against the PDFs. The sheet is ready; the marking has not been done.
- **Recall.** Nobody has listed everything that should have been found, so what was missed is unknown.
- **The five collapses.** A pre-registered backtest on five known failures and fifteen healthy controls is designed (protocol written, outcome rule fixed in advance) but has **not been run**; it needs the filings.
- **Other reports.** The five were chosen by the author. A different set will give different numbers, and NBFC-specific notes are not yet read.

Open edges, stated plainly

- Maturity tables were not read for TCS and HCLTech; related parties not for Infosys, Wipro and HCLTech.
- Wipro's borrowings flag (100% due within a year) says nothing about its cash; the finding sends the reader to the liquidity discussion.
- Fetching from BSE has been tested against a fake exchange only.
- Thresholds (for example 15% of net worth for related-party exposure) are starting assumptions, labelled as such wherever they appear.

How anyone can check it

Open any cited page in the filing and read the words. Rerun the scorecard on the same reports with `npm run score:notes`. Have a person outside the project mark the findings sheet, and the result will be published as it stands.

Next: a one-page forensic memo per company, the year-on-year change in the notes, and NBFC notes.